

Photo & Video Storage Options & Pricing

A cost and capability comparison for Site Tracker's crew photo storage, prepared from each provider's own pricing pages.

What's inside

- 1 The short answer - our recommendation
- 2 Side-by-side comparison at a glance
- 3 Each option in detail - free allowance, paid pricing, features
- 4 Sources

THE SHORT ANSWER

Our recommendation

Site Tracker stores every worker's site photo and video so an owner can review who took what, where, and when. That file storage currently runs on a service called Supabase. This document compares it against the other realistic options, with exact numbers pulled from each provider's own published pricing - not estimates.

What we recommend: upgrade the current storage plan (Supabase) to its paid tier, about **\$25/month**. This removes a reliability issue we found - the free plan quietly pauses itself after a week of inactivity, which is what caused photo uploads to stop working recently - and comfortably covers storage needs for a long time. No other changes are needed right now.

Looking further ahead: if photo and video volume grows a lot, and especially if owners/admins spend a lot of time browsing photo galleries, **Cloudflare R2** becomes the cheapest option at scale - it's the only one on this list that never charges anything for viewing/downloading files, no matter how much. That's a future option to revisit if usage grows, not something to switch to today.

A quick note on terms used in this document: **"free tier"** is what a provider gives away every month at no cost. **"Egress" / "bandwidth"** is the cost of people *viewing or downloading* files that are already stored - for a photo-heavy app like this, that cost can end up mattering more than the storage itself.

AT A GLANCE

Side-by-side comparison

Numbers are what each provider publishes on their own pricing page as of October 2026.

Cloud pricing changes over time - treat this as a snapshot, not a permanent guarantee.

	Free storage	Free to view/ download	Price per extra GB stored	Price per extra GB viewed	Needs a card for free tier?
Supabase (current)	1 GB	5 GB/month	\$0.0213/mo	\$0.03	No
Cloudflare R2	10 GB/month	Unlimited, always	\$0.015/mo	\$0 - free forever	Yes, to activate
Firebase Storage	5 GB	100 GB/month	~\$0.026/mo	~\$0.12	Yes (billing account)
AWS S3	None ongoing*	100 GB/month	\$0.023/mo	\$0.09 (first 10TB)	Yes
Backblaze B2	10 GB, permanent	~3x your storage/mo	\$0.00695/mo	\$0.01 (or \$0 via CDN)	Yes

* AWS gives new accounts a general credit, not an ongoing free storage allowance like the others.

The one reliability issue on this list: Supabase's free plan auto-pauses after 7 days with no activity - this is what broke photo uploads recently. Every other option here keeps running indefinitely with no activity. Moving to Supabase's paid plan removes this risk entirely.

IN DETAIL

Supabase Storage (current provider)

What Site Tracker uses today for photo and video files.

Free allowance

Storage	1 GB
Viewing/downloading	5 GB per month
Largest file size	50 MB
■■ Reliability	Pauses itself automatically after 7 days of no activity

If you need more (what you'd actually pay)

Paid plan	\$25/month base fee
Storage included in that plan	100 GB
Viewing included in that plan	250 GB/month
Extra storage beyond that	\$0.0213 per GB/month
Extra viewing beyond that	\$0.03 per GB

What else it gives you

Built-in photo resizing (100 free, then \$5 per 1,000 photos processed) - useful for generating thumbnails automatically. Simple to set up and already working in the app.

The paid plan removes the auto-pause risk entirely - this is the one change we'd recommend making regardless of anything else in this document.

Best for: a small-to-mid-size crew where photo volume stays modest and simplicity matters most.

Source: supabase.com/pricing (accessed October 2026)

Cloudflare R2

A storage service built around one standout feature: it never charges to view or download files.

Free allowance

Storage	10 GB, every month, ongoing
Upload-type actions	1,000,000/month
View/download actions	10,000,000/month
Viewing/downloading data itself	Unlimited, free

If you need more (what you'd actually pay)

Extra storage	\$0.015 per GB/month
Extra upload-type actions	\$4.50 per million
Extra view/download actions	\$0.36 per million
Viewing/downloading data	Still \$0, always

What else it gives you

No subscription fee required - pure pay-for-what-you-use beyond the free monthly allowance. A cheaper "infrequent access" storage tier is also available for old photos nobody looks at anymore.

Unlike the others' free tiers, Cloudflare asks for a card on file to switch R2 on, even though you won't be charged while staying within the free allowance. Also requires development work to switch to, since it doesn't use the same tools as the current setup.

Best for: if photo/video volume and gallery-browsing activity grow large - the free, unlimited viewing is what keeps costs flat even as usage grows.

Source: developers.cloudflare.com/r2/pricing (accessed October 2026)

Firebase Storage (Google)

Google's storage product - would let every part of the app's backend live under one provider.

Free allowance

Storage	5 GB
Viewing/downloading	100 GB/month
Upload actions	5,000/month
Download actions	50,000/month

If you need more (what you'd actually pay)

Extra storage	~\$0.026 per GB/month
Extra viewing/downloading	~\$0.12 per GB
Plan requirement	Requires enabling Google's "pay-as-you-go" billing plan

What else it gives you

The deepest feature set of any option here if ever needed: automatic rules to delete or archive old files, fine-grained access permissions, multi-region backup copies.

This is exactly the plan type the project originally avoided when it chose Supabase - Google requires a card on file for this feature even if usage stays within the free quota.

Best for: a team that wants everything - sign-in, database, and file storage - under a single Google account, and doesn't mind adding a payment method to that account now.

Source: firebase.google.com/pricing (accessed October 2026)

Amazon Web Services (AWS) S3

The most widely used cloud storage service in the industry, run by Amazon.

Free allowance

Ongoing free storage	None - only a general one-time new-account credit
Viewing/downloading	100 GB/month, shared across all Amazon services on the account

If you need more (what you'd actually pay)

Storage	\$0.023 per GB/month (first 50 TB)
Viewing/downloading - first 10 TB/month	\$0.09 per GB
Viewing/downloading - next 40 TB/month	\$0.085 per GB
Viewing/downloading - beyond that	Drops further, to as low as \$0.05 per GB at very high volume

What else it gives you

The largest ecosystem of any option - advanced permissions, automatic backup rules, and can be paired with Amazon's own content-delivery network to speed up photo loading worldwide.

The most setup effort of any option here, and the viewing/downloading cost is the highest per-GB of the group once you're past the small free allowance.

Best for: a larger operation that already uses other Amazon services, or expects to need enterprise-grade controls.

Source: aws.amazon.com/s3/pricing, cross-checked against CloudZero's 2026 S3 pricing guide (accessed October 2026)

Backblaze B2 (bonus option)

A smaller, less widely known provider - but the cheapest raw storage price of any option here, by a wide margin.

Free allowance

Storage	10 GB, permanent, every account
Viewing/downloading	About 3x whatever you're storing, per month

If you need more (what you'd actually pay)

Extra storage	\$0.00695 per GB/month - the cheapest on this list
Extra viewing/downloading	\$0.01 per GB (or \$0, if paired with a partner delivery network)

What else it gives you

Simple, predictable pricing with no minimum fees of any kind. Can reach the same "free unlimited viewing" benefit as Cloudflare R2, but only if paired with a separate delivery network in front of it.

Needs more technical assembly than the others to get its best pricing - it doesn't include the easy-to-use toolkit Supabase or Firebase provide out of the box.

Best for: a cost-conscious setup willing to do a bit more technical assembly (pairing it with a CDN) to get both the cheapest storage and free viewing at the same time.

Source: backblaze.com/b2/cloud-storage-pricing.html (accessed October 2026)

SOURCES

Where these numbers came from

Every figure in this document was read directly from the provider's own current pricing page, not estimated. Cloud pricing can change - we'd recommend re-checking these pages before making a final budget decision, especially if some time has passed since October 2026.

Provider	Source
Supabase	supabase.com/pricing
Cloudflare R2	developers.cloudflare.com/r2/pricing , plus developers.cloudflare.com/r2/get-started (billing setup)
Firebase Storage	firebase.google.com/pricing
AWS S3	aws.amazon.com/s3/pricing , cross-checked against cloudzero.com/blog/s3-pricing (2026 guide)
Backblaze B2	backblaze.com/b2/cloud-storage-pricing.html